

Fiat CR.32



From the first all-Italian fighter, the Celestino Rosatelli-designed CR.1 of 1923, came a series of excellent combat machines. Perhaps the best was the CR.32, which entered service in 1934. The aircraft was the main fighter of the Nationalist forces during the Spanish Civil War, in both Italian and Spanish Hispano-Suiza licensed versions. Over 1,100 were manufactured and exported widely.

ENGINE 600hp Fiat A30 RA V-12

WINGSPAN 31ft 2in (9.5m) **LENGTH** 24ft 5in (7.5m)

TOP SPEED 233mph (375kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 2 x machine guns

Gloster Gladiator

The last Royal Air Force biplane fighter and the first with four forward-firing machine guns, the Gladiator entered service in 1937, less than a year before Hurricanes began to replace them. Twenty-four squadrons were equipped with them until 1941. Two squadrons sent to France in 1939 were overwhelmed by the German attack in May 1940. By 1941, all Gladiators had been withdrawn from front-line duties.



ENGINE 830hp Bristol Mercury IX 9-cylinder radial

WINGSPAN 32ft 3in (9.8m) **LENGTH** 27ft 5in (8.2m)

TOP SPEED 257mph (414kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 4 x .303in Browning machine guns

Grumman FF-1

The relationship with the US Navy that made the name Grumman synonymous with naval aircraft, began on April 2, 1931, when a contract was signed for a tubby biplane with unique features – a retractable undercarriage and an enclosed cockpit. Although the navy only acquired 27 FF-1s and 33 SF-1s (the reconnaissance version), the link was forged to such immortal aircraft as the Wildcat, Hellcat, and ultimately the Tomcat of *Top Gun* fame.



ENGINE 700hp Wright Cyclone 9-cylinder radial

WINGSPAN 34ft 6in (10.5m) **LENGTH** 24ft 6in (7.5m)

TOP SPEED 207mph (333kph) **CREW** 2

ARMAMENT 3 x machine guns

Hawker Hart

525hp Rolls-Royce
Kestrel V12 engine

Sleek fuselage
design



ENGINE 525hp Rolls-Royce Kestrel 1B V-12

WINGSPAN 37ft 3in (11.4m) **LENGTH** 29ft 4in (8.9m)

TOP SPEED 184mph (296kph) **CREW** 2

ARMAMENT 2 x machine guns; 500lb (226kg) bombload

The 1930s Hawker family of sleek biplane fighters and bombers built around the renowned Kestrel engine were probably the most attractive British aircraft of their era. The first of that family was the superb Hart light bomber. First flown in June 1928, it was faster than contemporary RAF fighters and was quickly put into production. Over 500 Harts were manufactured and exported widely, and the Hart continued to serve the RAF until 1938.

Heinkel He 51

Designed and built in secret, since Germany was not permitted to build fighters, the first He 51 flew in 1933 and deliveries to the Luftwaffe started in early 1935. Constantly improved, over 700 were built, of which the final variant was the He 51C, designed for a ground attack role. During the Spanish Civil War, He 51s were flown by the Nationalists and German Condor Legion.

ENGINE 750hp BMW VI V-12

WINGSPAN 36ft 1in (11m) **LENGTH** 27ft 6in (8.4m)

TOP SPEED 205mph (330kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 2 x machine guns



Martin B-10B (Model 139)

The B-10B first flew in 1932, during a time of rapid aeronautical development. It was the first US all-metal bomber to go into production, had the first gun turret, and was as fast as the Army's fighters. However, the production of more advanced bombers, such as the Boeing B-17, limited its military role, although it continued to be manufactured for export until 1939.



ENGINE 2 x 775hp Wright R-1820 Cyclone 9-cylinder radials

WINGSPAN 70ft 6in (21.5m) **LENGTH** 44ft 9in (13.6m)

TOP SPEED 213mph (343kph) **CREW** 4

ARMAMENT 3 x machine guns; 2,260lb (1,025kg) bombload

Nakajima Ki-27 "Nate" (Type 97)

First flown in July 1936, the Ki-27, or Army Type 97, entered operational service with the Japanese Army in March 1938. A total of 3,999 were built between late 1937 and the end of 1942, with many ending their careers as kamikaze bombers.



ENGINE 500hp Nakajima-built Bristol Jupiter 9-cylinder radial

WINGSPAN 36ft 1in (11m) **LENGTH** 23ft 10in (7.3m)

TOP SPEED 186mph (299kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 2 x machine guns

Nieuport Type 52

Similar to the Type 62 C1, which served with the French air force, the Type 52, chosen by the Spanish air force from 1929 to 1936, had an all-metal construction. At the outbreak of the Spanish Civil War, it fought on both Nationalist and Republican sides.

ENGINE 580hp Hispano-Suiza 12Hb inline

WINGSPAN 39ft 5in (12m) **LENGTH** 25ft 1in (7.7m)

TOP SPEED 155mph (249kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 2 x machine guns

